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JellyfinToZidoo issue #4 — resume position diagnosis + fix plan

1 message

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Notes from the log investigation on issue #4, saved here so you have them when you get home. Nothing has been changed in the repo — no code, no commits, no pushes. This is analysis only.

Short version: the Zidoo's `getPlayStatus` returns a BLANK path whenever the player isn't sitting on a file — both while it's still opening one and while it tears down on exit. The app treats that blank as a real path, which makes a slow-opening file look like the user jumped to a different file. It then cuts the session loose from the Jellyfin item and silently stops reporting anything for the rest of playback. It's a race against how fast the file opens, which is why it's intermittent for us and total for him.

Full write-up below.

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ISSUE #4 — resume position not saved (still broken in v2026.09.3)

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Reported by @3DBuff on a Z9X (fw 6.4.68), Jellyfin 12.0, reproduced on both the official Android TV client 0.19.10 and Wholphin 1.0.8. Diagnosed from the logs he attached on 2026-09-15. NOT YET FIXED. No code has been changed for this.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS

The app stops reporting to the server about ten seconds into playback and never resumes. It keeps polling and logging positions correctly the whole time — it just posts none of them.

From his logcat (jftz.log):

```
18:16:05.243 Zidoo advanced to next file: /storage/8ED032A8D0329705/.../The Runner ...mkv
18:16:05.420 Binge episode not found by path: No item found matching path
18:16:15 - 18:17:58 Poll: pos=509462 ... 619750 <- 13 polls, all correct, all unreported
```

His server log for the same window:

```
18:15:57 started playback ("JellyfinToZidoo" "2026.09.3")
<- nothing else for this session, ever
18:19:31 started playback <- the Wholphin run
18:25:57 stopped playback at "499491"ms <- 4 min after he actually exited
```

499491 ms is the position playback STARTED from, not the 10:23 where he stopped. That 18:25:57 line is Jellyfin ageing the session out and recording the last position it was ever told. The app itself sent nothing after the start report.

The correct position was available the whole time — at 18:18:06.477 the Zidoo broadcast `currentPosition: 619750` — and at 18:18:25 ActivityManager killed the app process as empty, having reported none of it.

ROOT CAUSE

`currentPlayingPath` is never seeded from the path we launch with. It is only ever set

from whatever the first poll sees (Play.java:1055), and the poller's first run is 3 s after launch (Play.java:905).

The Zidoo's `getPlayStatus` returns a BLANK path whenever the player is not sitting on a file — both while it is still opening one and while it tears down on exit. (Proof that it returns blank rather than omitting the field: the empty-path log line at 18:21:53 in `jftz_wholphin.log`, and the fact that the advance branch fired at all, which requires `currentPlayingPath` to be non-null.)

So on a file that takes longer than ~3 s to open:

1. First poll catches the player still opening -> blank path -> `currentPlayingPath = ""`
2. Next poll sees the real path -> `isSameZidooFile(realPath, "")` is false (Play.java:941-942, because `normalizeZidooPath("")` returns null) -> "Zidoo advanced to next file"
3. The binge lookup runs and fails -> `jellyfinItemId = ""`, `playSessionId = ""` (Play.java:1043, and the same at :1050)
4. That gates off progress reporting (Play.java:1097) and the stop report (Play.java:1514) for the rest of the session. The stop guard returns silently with no log line, which is why logcat shows nothing at all at exit.

The lookup in step 3 fails for two independent reasons: `searchItemByPath` sends `IncludeItemTypes=Episode` (JellyfinApi.java:1441) so a movie can never match, and `extractSearchName` searches on the release-name stem ("The Runner 2026.2160p.DV.HDR.WEB.EAC3.5.1.H265"), which would not match the item name "The Runner" even for an episode.

WHY IT'S INTERMITTENT ON OUR OWN BOX BUT TOTAL FOR HIM

It's a race against how fast the file opens.

- Opens in under ~3 s -> first poll sees the real path -> nothing looks like a file change -> progress and stop both report -> works.
- Opens slower -> blank first, real path second -> session cut loose -> nothing reported.

Big 4K/DV remuxes, a cold drive, first play after a reboot, a busy network all lose the race; a small or recently-played file wins it. The same title can go either way on consecutive attempts. All three of his runs took 10-19 s to open, so he never wins.

SECOND, INDEPENDENT RACE AT THE EXIT. The player returns the same blank path while shutting down. In his Wholphin run that poll landed 0.65 s before the player handed control back (`jftz_wholphin.log` 18:21:53.762, activity finish 18:21:54.417). If a poll lands in that window the item id is cleared just before `onActivityResult` checks it, and the stop is skipped. This one can bite even when startup went fine, and is likelier in the last minute of a file where polling speeds up to 3 s.

WHAT THE v2026.09.3 FIX DID AND DID NOT COVER

4068ed4 ("Treat the Zidoo's mounted SMB path and the launch URI as the same file") taught `normalizeZidooPath` the `/data/system/smb/<host>#<share>` spelling. That is a real fix for the SMB-spelling case, but it does not touch the blank-path case, which is the one that fires here.

Also worth correcting in the issue thread: the theory posted on 2026-09-10 — that the official client fires its own position-less stop and overwrites ours — is NOT what is happening on his box. His server log shows no stop from Jellyfin Android TV at all. Nothing is overwriting our report; there is no report.

THE FIX (not written — this is the plan)

Main change, closes both races:

- Treat a blank path from `getPlayStatus` as "no file open", not as a path. Never seed `currentPlayingPath` from one, never compare against one. A blank means the player is between files, not that the user switched files.

Hardening, none of it the main event:

- On a failed lookup, don't just drop the item id. Report a stop for the item we were already on, at its last known position, before letting go — so a genuine episode change doesn't cost the resume point of what was just watched.
- Widen the lookup past `IncludelItemTypes=Episode` so movies can match.
- Add a log line to the silent bail at `Play.java:1514`. With one there this would have been obvious from `logcat` instead of needing the server log to prove it.

Suggested seam for tests: a package-private static on `JellyfinApi` that decides "is this a real file change", requiring a usable path on both sides, matching how `isSameZidooFile` and `shouldApplyTrackSelection` are already structured.

VERIFYING ON THE LIVE PLAYER

The bug is in how the app reads the player's answers, so the bad case is reproducible on purpose rather than by luck: play something large and slow to open for the failing case, and something small or freshly-played for the passing case. If it fails on one and works on the other, that confirms the mechanism without having to catch it at random.

Watch for "Zidoo advanced to next file:" with nothing after the colon — that line appearing at all on a single-file playback means the race was lost.

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Source logs are the five files @3DBuff attached to issue #4 on 2026-09-15:
`full.log`, `full_wholphin.log`, `jftz.log`, `jftz_wholphin.log`, `jellyfin20260914.log`

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